14 R.C. BHARGAVA, 88

CHAIRMAN, MARUTI SUZUKI

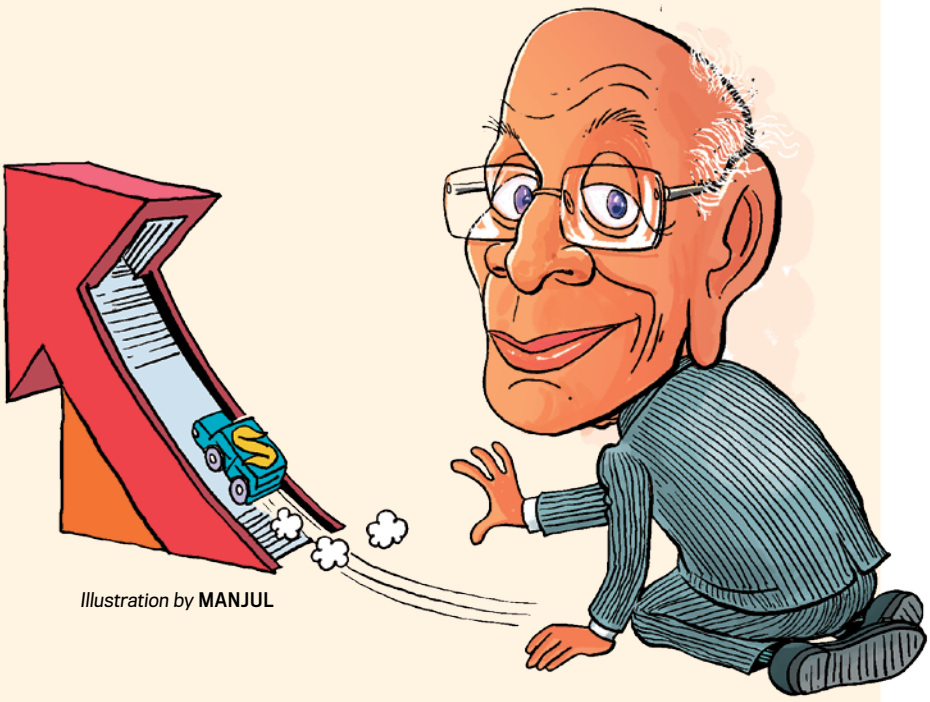


Illustration by **MANJUL**

IN POLE POSITION

BECAUSE he is the most respected voice in the Indian automotive industry. He steered Maruti Suzuki, India's largest car manufacturer, through yet another tough year that saw a big shortage of electronic components. Despite that, the company posted its highest ever total sales of 1.9 million-plus units in 2022-23

BECAUSE Maruti Suzuki's domestic sales grew 20.5 per cent over 2021-22, while the company also saw the highest-ever exports of 259,333 units

BECAUSE Maruti Suzuki recently entered the league of top-30 automobile manufacturers globally after it became the first passenger vehicle maker in the country to cross Rs 1 lakh crore in revenue

SPEAKING OUT Likes to be frank and forthright, be it articulating his concerns over the rising cost of vehicles due to regulatory obligations or that electric vehicles alone cannot solve the issue of CO2 emissions

THE PLAYER Bhargava used to play cricket in school and was on the university squash team. Was a regular golf player until recently

15 AJAY PIRAMAL, 67

CHAIRMAN, PIRAMAL GROUP

The Value Creator

BECAUSE he is constantly tapping into big business opportunities in India, and in August 2022 the group flagship Piramal Enterprises demerged its pharma business and simplified its corporate structure, creating two separate listed entities: Piramal Enterprises, a non-banking financial company (NBFC), and Piramal Pharma. In October 2022, the latter was listed on the BSE and the NSE

BECAUSE in December 2022, Piramal Finance, which completed the acquisition of



Illustration by **ROUNAK PATRA**